

THE ULTIMATE GIT & GITHUB CHEAT SHEET

1. Setup & Configuration (Once per computer)

- * git config --global user.name "Your Name" -> Sets your display name.
- * git config --global user.email "your@email.com" -> Sets your email address.
- * git config --list -> Lists all saved settings.

2. Starting Projects

- * git init -> Turns folder into a Git repository.
- * git clone <url> -> Downloads a repository from GitHub.

3. The Daily Workflow (Stage & Save)

- * git status -> Shows files modified or untracked.
- * git add <filename> -> Stages a specific file for a save.
- * git add . -> Stages ALL changed files at once.
- * git commit -m "your message" -> Saves snapshot permanently offline.
- * git log --oneline -> Shows a clean, short history list.

4. Working with Branches (Safe Experiments)

- * git branch -> Lists all local branches.
- * git checkout -b <branch-name> -> Creates and switches to new branch.
- * git checkout <branch-name> -> Switches to an existing branch.
- * git merge <branch-name> -> Merges sub-branch into current branch.
- * git branch -d <branch-name> -> Deletes a local branch.

5. Sharing with GitHub (Cloud Connection)

- * git remote add origin <github-url> -> Links local folder to GitHub page.
- * git remote -v -> Lists all connected cloud links.
- * git branch -M main -> Renames primary branch to 'main'.
- * git push -u origin main -> First-time upload to GitHub 'main'.
- * git push -> Uploads new commits to GitHub.
- * git pull -> Downloads and merges cloud changes.

6. Emergency & Cleanup

- * git checkout -- <filename> -> Discards changes since last save.
- * git reset --soft HEAD~1 -> Undoes last commit; keeps your code.
- * rm -rf .git -> Nuclear option: Deletes all tracking.